

Summary

In this lesson, students learn how to analyze stories written in Twine and break them down into “passages”, the fundamental building block of interactive story games. Students will read a story written in Twine, analyze its components, create an outline of the story, and finally create a plan for their own original story that they’ll create at the end of the unit.

Grade Level: 5-8 Topic Area: Algorithms & Programming Estimated Lesson Duration: 90 minutes

Learning Objectives

The students will be able to . . .

1. Break down a story created with Twine into passages
2. Identify plot elements of a short story, including protagonist(s), antagonist(s), conflict, and resolution(s)
3. Outline an original story with multiple endings
4. Practice essential literacy skills to read, interpret, and analyze Twine stories

Standards Alignment

Read the complete text of the standards referenced below on the [CodeVA Curriculum Library](#).

Subject Area	Standards
Computer Science	Virginia SOLs: 5.1a, 5.2a, 5.3-5; 6.2; 7.1b, 7.2-4; 8.2, 8.4
English & Language Arts	Virginia SOLs: 5.FFR.1-3, 5-8.DSR, 5-8.RV.1, 5-8.RL.1-2, 5-8.R.1

Materials

- A computer or laptop with an Internet connection (at least 1 for every 3 students, 1:1 preferred)
- Access to the [Twine Trail Guide](#) tutorial website created by CodeVA
- Sticky notes (e.g., Post-It notes), anchor charts, writing implements
- The [Story Analysis Worksheet](#), print 1 for each student group (3 students per group recommended; [see below](#), [printable PDF](#))
- Adventure on the Rogue*, a short Twine story ([HTML file for import](#))
- The [Unit 1 Project Design Menu](#), print 1 per student ([editable Google Drawing](#), [printable PDF](#))
- The [Random Story Elements](#) table, print 1 per student group ([see below](#), [printable PDF](#))

Vocabulary

Term	Definition
passage	A “page” from a Twine story, self-contained text
link	A word or phrase the reader can click to visit another passage in Twine
outline	A document explaining the overall pieces of a story or essay
plot	The events of a story, often categorized into “beginning”, “middle”, and “end”
protagonist	The “good” character; the character the reader wants to succeed (usually)
antagonist	The “bad” character who stands in opposition to the protagonist
conflict	The disagreement between the protagonist and the antagonist
resolution	The event that ends the conflict between the protagonist and the antagonist

Before the Lesson

There are no prerequisites for this lesson.

Lesson Outline

1. **Start by letting students know that they’ll be creating original interactive stories. Then, engage them in a discussion about what makes a good story.** Prompt discussion by asking questions like:

- *What sorts of things excite you when you are watching a movie, reading a book, or playing a videogame?*
- *If you were in charge of making a movie, book, or videogame, what sorts of things would you include in the story?*
- *What are some things you’d want to avoid if you were writing the perfect story?*

Have students record their responses using sticky notes and anchor charts, and then create a checklist with all the things students think a good story includes.

Annotations & Notes

It’s not that important what things end up on the checklist here, but it’s a good moment to gauge students’ media literacy. They might end up coming up with very sophisticated ideas, but they also might need some support analyzing the stories they enjoy.

2. **Have students work in small groups (about 3 per group) to play through one of the stories linked below**, rating the story according to the checklist they create in step #1. Show students how to upload the stories to Twine:

- Story #1: [How Brother Terrapin Rode in the Clouds](#)
- Story #2: [Dem Bones](#)
- Story #3: [La Llorona](#)

Have students answer the following questions as they play through their story. You can have students record their responses on the [Story Analysis Worksheet](#), or have them keep their own notes as a group:

- *Who is the story's **protagonist**?*
- *Who is the story's **antagonist**?*
- *What is the main **conflict** in the story?*
- *How does the story **resolve** the conflict in its different endings?*
- *What could you change about the story to make it better?*

This step might take a while, about 15-20 minutes. Each story has at least two possible endings, so make sure students play through the stories enough times that they get all the endings.

3. **Have students share their work with one another.** Ask students to:

- Summarize their story
- Share their responses to the prompts on the [Story Analysis Worksheet](#)/in step #2

Don't spend too long on this, and don't give students a ton of time to prepare unless you think it's a valuable use of instructional time. This should be a quick, informal share-out.

4. **Introduce the idea that each story is made up of passages which are linked together.** Each passage is a "page", and each link leads to another. Then, have students work together to break down one of the sample stories linked in step #2 into passages using sticky notes and an anchor chart. Have students use the following instructions as guidance:

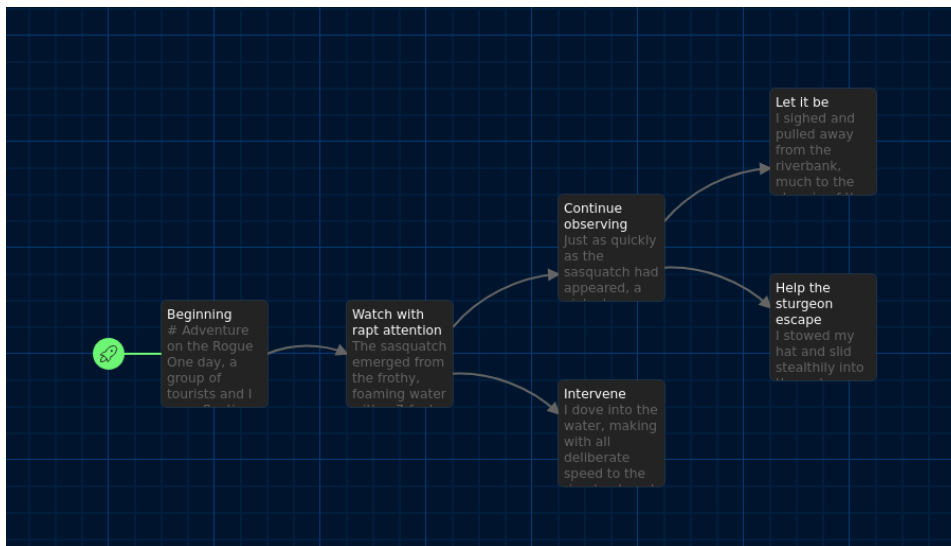
- *For each passage, add a sticky note to the anchor chart. Make up a title for the passage, and write it on the sticky note.*
- *For each link, draw a line from the passage that contains the link to the passage that the link leads to.*

As students play through the stories, float around the room and check on groups to make sure they understand what to do.

If students aren't familiar with these terms yet, briefly explain what they mean and provide a reference for the definition (see [Vocabulary Reference](#) below)

Don't be stingy with support here. If students make mistakes in their responses, gently steer them in the right direction and move on. Follow up with groups who are struggling if needed.

You can use this story's diagram (see below, [image file](#)) as an example:
[Adventure on the Rogue](#)



5. **Next, have students compare their diagrams to the Twine flowcharts associated with each story.** If students notice differences between their story diagram and the Twine diagram, have them make corrections to their diagram.

Note: The placement of sticky notes/passages isn't super crucial—just the connections between passages.

Use the diagram (see above, [image file](#)) from the sample story in step #4 to model this analysis if needed.

6. **Remind students that next, they'll be creating their own stories. Have them outline their story using the [Unit 1 Project Design Menu](#).** In order to complete the design menu, students will need to:

- Identify a protagonist, antagonist, and conflict
- Summarize the different endings their story will have
- Make a plan for which decisions the reader will make in the story

If students are having trouble coming up with ideas, use the [Random Story Elements](#) table to prompt some ideas. End the session by having students share their story ideas with one another.

Be ready to provide support as students work through the project design menu. Don't be prescriptive about what they should write; instead, prompt them to come up with creative ideas of their own.

Assessment Strategies

In addition to formative assessments (see [Lesson Outline](#) above), here are some summative opportunities:

Unit #1 Project Design Menu

Assesses Learning Objectives #1-3

Students will use the [Unit 1 Project Design Menu](#) document to outline a story with multiple endings that they will create with Twine at the end of the unit. The [Lesson Outline](#) above provides details about when to have students complete this assignment. You can view printable versions of *Unit #1 Project Design Menu* at the following links:

- [Unit #1 Project Design Menu \(Google Drawing\)](#)
- [Unit #1 Project Design Menu \(printable PDF\)](#)

After students complete the assignment, use the one-point rubric below to assess students' work. You can find [printable rubrics to share with students below](#).

Unit 1 Project Design Menu

Name: _____ Date: _____

Project Prompt: After you've learned to code with Twine, you'll write an original story. Your story should have more than one ending, and should be about the conflict between a protagonist and antagonist of your choice. Select goals from the menu below, or fill in the blanks to make up your own goals.

3 points		5 points	
Uses 3 unfamiliar words	☐	Story has more than two possible endings	☐
Antagonist is the environment/nature	☐	Antagonist is technology	☐
Story has a good ending & a bad ending	☐	Conflict is emotional, but nonviolent	☐
Story remixes another tale	☐	Story is historical	☐
_____	☐	Story has a moral message for the reader	☐
_____	☐	_____	☐
(name your protagonist)	☐	_____	☐
(name your antagonist)	☐	_____	☐

Summarize your story by describing the protagonist, antagonist, their conflict, and how the conflict might resolve (12 points):

Total: ____/30

	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing
Plot Elements		Identifies a protagonist, an antagonist, a conflict, and one or more resolutions for their story.	
Decomposition		Identifies decisions the reader will need to make in the story to lead to one of the story's multiple endings.	
Story Outline		Outlines a story with a beginning, middle, and at least two possible endings.	

Note: The rubric above is a "one-point rubric". To use, circle the appropriate cell for each criteria. If the student's work is "exemplary" or "developing", use the space in the cell to explain your assessment.

Story Analysis Worksheet

Answer the questions below about your selected story

Name: _____

1. Who is the protagonist in your story? _____
2. Who is the antagonist in your story? _____

3. Describe the main <u>conflict</u> between characters in your story:	4. Describe how the conflict is <u>resolved</u> in the different endings to the story:

5. Write a 3-sentence summary of your story by filling in the blanks below:

"In my story, the conflict takes place between _____ and _____.

The story has two endings, one where _____,
and one where _____."

Vocabulary Reference

Term	Definition
protagonist	The "good" character; the character the reader wants to succeed (usually)
antagonist	The "bad" character who stands in opposition to the protagonist

conflict	The disagreement between the protagonist and the antagonist
resolution; “resolve”	The event that ends the conflict between the protagonist and the antagonist

Random Story Elements Table

Use the table below to generate ideas for your story randomly. You can use dice, a random number generator, or other randomization techniques (e.g., darts, cut up slips in a hat, etc.) to choose, or just choose one you like.

Protagonists	Antagonists	Conflicts
An urchin child with a heart of gold living on the street	A morally corrupt authority figure extorting community members	A duel to the death must take place to resolve an argument
A lawyer trying to win a case against the odds	A criminal mastermind attempting the heist of the century	The law must apprehend, the criminal must escape
A hard-boiled detective who doesn't play by the rules	A harsh, unforgiving wilderness environment	The characters are in love, but can't reveal it
An aristocratic woman who abandons her wealth	A hostile and dangerous technology	The characters must get into the secret club at any cost
A plucky, clever fox who knows how to talk to humans	The unjust expectations of society imposed on the protagonist	The characters must address an injustice in their community
A scientist working on a problem to save her town	A preacher who manipulates his church into doing evil deeds	The characters need to go find something important
An explorer discovering the remnants of an ancient people	A dangerous monster or wild animal terrorizing the town	The characters must hide something from the enemy
A navy sailor who resorts to piracy to escape unjust orders	A magical threat from beyond reality; an occult monstrosity	The characters' parents never let them do anything

A nature spirit who doesn't know much about humans (yet)	A stuffy politician refusing to do what is right	The character is persecuted based on who they are
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Printable Rubrics

Student Name: _____

Date: _____

	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing
Plot Elements		Identifies a protagonist, an antagonist, a conflict, and one or more resolutions for their story.	
Decomposition		Identifies decisions the reader will need to make in the story to lead to one of the story's multiple endings.	
Story Outline		Outlines a story with a beginning, middle, and at least two possible endings.	

Student Name: _____

Date: _____

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